



Cambridge (CIE) IGCSE English Language



Your notes

Section A: Directed Writing

Contents

- * Question 1 Directed Writing: What the Question is Asking
- * Question 1 Directed Writing: How to Write a Speech
- * Question 1 Directed Writing: How to Write a Letter
- * Question 1 Directed Writing: How to Write an Article
- * Question 1 Directed Writing Skills: SPaG
- * Question 1 Model Answer: Speech
- * Question 1 Model Answer: Letter
- * Question 1 Model Answer: Article



Your notes

Question 1 Directed Writing: What the Question is Asking

Question 1 Directed Writing: What the Question is Asking

Question 1 on Paper 2 is the Directed Writing question and it is compulsory. Your piece of writing will be based on one or two reading passages, and you will be asked to write in the format of either a speech, letter or article.

The following guide will provide you with the information you need to answer **Question 1: Directed Writing** to a high standard.

Overview

Although Question 1 is mainly an assessment of your writing skills, your piece of writing will be based on one or two reading texts. This means that, of the total of 40 available marks, 25 are awarded for your writing skills, and 15 are based on your reading skills.

This means that you will have to use, evaluate and develop the information and ideas in the reading text or texts in order to craft your response in the form of a letter, article or speech. Ideally, you will be using some of the same skills that you demonstrated in Paper 1, Question 3, such as your written response being in your own words. You are not being assessed on your ability to quote directly from the text or texts, or to repeat the exact words of the texts.

You should write between 250 and 350 words, which is 1½ to 2 sides of A4 in standard handwriting. In order to get the highest marks, you need to demonstrate the following skills:

- The ability to write in a highly effective style, capable of conveying subtle meanings (W1)
- The ability to structure your writing carefully for the benefit of your reader (W2)
- The ability to use a wide range of sophisticated vocabulary, used precisely and accurately (W3)
- The ability to write in highly effective language and an appropriate tone for your audience and purpose (W4)
- The ability to write with virtually no errors in spelling, grammar and punctuation (W5)
- The ability to successfully evaluate ideas and opinions, both explicit and implicit (R1–R3)
- The ability to assimilate ideas from the text(s) to give a developed and sophisticated response (R3 and R5)

Breaking down the question

In Question 1, you will be given a scenario based on the themes of the reading text(s). You will be told the context, the format of your writing and who you are writing for. You should always approach this question by reading the task carefully first, and highlighting what is sometimes referred to as a GAP analysis, or the “3 Ws”:



Your notes

G	A	P
Genre (format)	Audience	Purpose
What am I writing?	Who am I writing for?	Why am I writing?

For example:

Read Text A and Text B in the insert and then answer **Section A, Question 1** on this question paper.

Section A: Directed Writing

Question 1

A relative is considering moving to another country where they and their teenage children will have to learn a new language.

Write a letter to your relative giving your views about whether or not this is a good idea.

In your letter you should:

- evaluate the ideas, opinions and attitudes in both texts
- explain how successful you think the move will be for the adults and their children.

Base your letter on what you have read in **both** texts, but be careful to use your own words.
Address both of the bullet points.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

This gives you the scenario

Genre = letter
Audience = your relative
Purpose = to give your views

These instructions are reminders of how to write your answer

You should address both bullet points in your answer

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved

You should spend 15–20 minutes reading and planning your response, and 40–45 minutes writing your response (allowing a few minutes at the end for re-reading and checking).



Examiner Tips and Tricks



Your notes

Remember, Question 1 requires an extended written response. Therefore, the most effective answers will demonstrate a well-planned structure covering a range of points written in the correct form. It is important to sign off your letter appropriately or give your article a headline. Make sure you have correctly identified the format required in the task, and avoid writing letters to indiscriminate recipients, or writing speeches for unspecified events. Respond to what the task is, rather than what you hoped it would be.

Language, audience and purpose

Your audience for this task will be the intended recipients or audience for your piece of writing. Part of what you are being assessed on is your ability to adapt your language and tone to suit this intended audience.

For example:

- A parent will have different concerns and values to a student
- A local MP would need convincing using facts and evidence to be persuaded by your arguments
- Readers of a local newspaper would be more persuaded by emotive language
- A letter to a headteacher or someone in authority requires formal, respectful language which is not aggressive or inappropriate
- Teenagers would need something to relate to, so personal anecdotes would work well

Addressing your audience or reader specifically is a convincing technique to persuade people to agree with your point of view, or at least to acknowledge its validity; you can also use inclusive language, such as “we” and “us”, or “fellow students” or “parents”. You should always write using Standard English, but the level of formality you should employ will be dictated by the task itself.

For example:

Target audience	Example of how to adapt language
Teenagers	<i>I'm sure we've all had our parents or guardians moan at us for how long we spend on our gaming machines. However, gaming can help us develop important skills, such as teamwork, as well as being an awesome way of connecting with friends from all over the world!</i>
The use of inclusive pronouns and colloquial language , such as “awesome”, demonstrates that this example is aimed at teenagers or younger people	
Adults	<i>Using animals for sports, such as fox-hunting, has been debated for many years, and it is an issue which elicits strong emotions from both sides.</i>



Your notes

The use of more sophisticated vocabulary, such as “elicits”, as well as complex sentences, demonstrate that this is aimed at adults reading about a serious topic

Older people

The purpose of wearable technology, such as smart-watches and fitness trackers, is to make staying connected as easy and hands-free as possible. In addition, wearable technology can have important health benefits, as they can monitor your blood sugars, heart rate, blood pressure and quality of sleep.

The simple explanations and examples show that this is written for people who might not know much about wearable technology

Question 1 will also ask you to write for a specific purpose. You will be asked to create a discursive, argumentative or persuasive response, using your own words. This means that you will be rewarded for your ability to select relevant language techniques and employ them in a sophisticated way. A useful acronym to remember some of the key language techniques for this type of writing is DAN FOREST PIE:

Device	Definition	Example
Direct address	Addressing your audience directly to build rapport	<i>When it comes to the issue of animal cruelty, you cannot stand back and not take a stand. This is your fight as well.</i>
Audience	Acknowledging the whole of your audience in your writing	<i>Parents, you must surely agree that banning mobile phones in classrooms will improve concentration and enable your children to make better progress in their studies.</i>
Not only, but also	Used as part of your sentence to add to an argument	<i>Not only does this issue affect local communities, but it also has wider implications for the whole of the country.</i>
Facts	Something that can be proven to be true	<i>London Zoo is the oldest zoo in the UK.</i>
Opinions	What you believe or think, often presented as fact	<i>In my view, banning fox hunting with hounds is the best thing to have happened for a long time.</i>

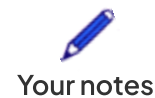


Your notes

Rhetorical questions	A question which does not require an answer	<i>Is it right that reality TV stars are paid vast amounts of money while not actually having any skills?</i>
Emotive language	Language deliberately chosen to make the audience or reader feel a particular emotion or have an emotional response	<i>The horribly cruel, brutal and violent manner in which hunting hounds murder a fox when caught, ripping them apart, is completely wrong.</i>
Statistics	Factual data used in a persuasive way	<i>80% of commuters agree that rail fares currently do not represent good value for money.</i>
Triplets	Three ideas or examples in a sentence used to emphasise a point	<i>Nutritious, delicious and environmentally conscious, plant-based eating is the only way to reduce our impact on the environment.</i>
Personal and inclusive pronouns	"I", "you", "we", "us"	<i>We must act now on climate change, as it matters not only to us, but to our children and children's children.</i>
Imperatives	Command verbs	<i>Act now, as further delay could be catastrophic.</i>
Exaggeration	Also known as hyperbole – exaggerated language or examples used for effect	<i>If we do nothing, we will regret our inaction for the rest of eternity.</i>

You could also consider using:

Flattery	Complimenting your readers or audience	<i>As well-educated and intelligent people, I am sure you will agree that this situation must not continue.</i>
Alliteration	Two or more words that begin with the same consonant sounds – the words do not have to be consecutive	<i>Is fast food making us fatter, or is this idea just a fad?</i>



Antithesis	Opposing words or ideas presented together to show a contrast	<i>Just a small act of defiance could have a huge effect.</i>
Double adjectives	Starting your sentence with two adjectives	<i>Smart and exciting, new wearable technology is the latest craze.</i>

It is also important to carefully consider the purpose of the task. "Giving your views" about a subject can mean to explain what you think, to argue your point or to persuade your audience to agree with you. Most importantly, your language and tone needs to match your intended audience and purpose.

Purpose	Devices and techniques to demonstrate you understand the purpose of the task
Write to explain: ▪ "Explain your point of view about..." ▪ "Explain your attitude to..." ▪ "Explain your thoughts on..."	▪ Provide reasons for your ideas ▪ Offer examples and anecdotes: ▪ Use imagery to describe experiences ▪ Provide facts and statistics: ▪ In the exam you can use those provided in the reading texts ▪ Use present-tense verbs: ▪ Usually you are explaining about something that is currently the case ▪ Use either first or third person consistently Use appropriate connectives: ▪ Words like "Moreover", "Furthermore", "However" and "On the other hand" provide cohesion and fluency
Write to argue: ▪ "Argue your point of view about..." ▪ "Give your views on..."	▪ Write in the first person as you are putting forward your thoughts and opinions ▪ Use personal and inclusive pronouns: ▪ Using words like "we" and "us" builds rapport between you and your reader and makes them feel involved ▪ Present your opinions as facts - as a truth that shouldn't be challenged



Your notes

	- Be persuasive and passionate about your argument, but not aggressive: - Readers do not respond well to an aggressive tone - Use emotive language and rhetorical questions to persuade your reader of the validity of your argument - You can present both sides of an argument, but decide on your position and maintain it throughout: - This means that you can start your counter-argument with phrases such as “While I acknowledge that some people might think...” - Then circle back to your original position
Write to persuade: “Persuade the audience of your point of view about...”	- Write in the first person as you are putting forward your thoughts and opinions - Use personal and inclusive pronouns: - Using words like “we” and “us” builds rapport between you and your reader and makes them feel involved - Present your opinions as facts – as a truth that shouldn’t be challenged - Be persuasive and passionate about your argument, but not aggressive: - Readers do not respond well to an aggressive tone - Use emotive language and rhetorical questions to persuade your reader of the validity of your argument - Use imperatives to call your audience to action - Use rhetorical techniques such as the rule of three to convince the reader of your argument - Decide on your position or opinion and stick to it throughout - Avoid sounding like an advertisement

Above all, remember: your arguments and point of view must be based on the reading passages you are given. If you just write without establishing a clear summary of the main points in the text(s), you will not score high marks.



Examiner Tips and Tricks

As part of your planning and preparation for this task, you should write a summary of your argument in response to the task in a single sentence. This should be included in your introductory paragraph, establishing your position, and confirmed in the concluding paragraph. The highest marks are achieved when you are able to establish a central argument and sustain this throughout your writing.



Your notes

Steps to success

1. Read the task carefully:

- Identify and highlight **what** you are writing, **who** you are writing for and **why** you are writing
- Also highlight the **main focus** in each bullet point in the task

2. Read the text(s):

- Highlight evidence or information relevant to the focus of each bullet point

3. Plan your response:

- Turn what you have highlighted in the text(s) into bullet points, summarising the information or idea *in your own words*

4. Make your point of view clear in your introduction:

- If you are writing a letter, state what you are writing about, why you are writing and what your point of view is
- If you are writing a speech, introduce your audience to the topic of your speech and your point of view
- If you are writing an article, consider an introduction that grabs your reader's attention while also indicating your viewpoint

5. Start each paragraph with an appropriate connective and topic sentence

6. Develop each paragraph in detail:

- Make your point using the information or ideas from the text:
 1. To do this, you need to read between the lines in the text(s)
 2. Your ideas and opinions must be derived from the passage
- Explain what you mean

- Develop your point, assessing its implications with clear and persuasive arguments
- Make sure you have developed your point thoroughly before moving on to your next point (which should be a different point or argument)

7. Try to leave five minutes at the end to re-read your writing carefully, correcting any obvious mistakes you have made

Exam tips:

- Make sure that you employ fluent, varied sentence styles and a wide range of vocabulary
- Structure your ideas and organise your responses effectively to persuade, discuss ideas and engage the reader
- Do not just copy from the reading texts:
 - This will seriously limit both your reading and writing marks
- Likewise, do not quote from the text(s)
- Nor should you just repeat the ideas in the text(s):
 - You need to select relevant points and evaluate them
 - Remember, you are not producing a summary of the text(s)
 - Make sure you do not just lift points from the text and discuss them generally
- It is important to plan your response and decide what your arguments are going to be:
 - Recognise that there may be implicit meanings in the text, which you need to be aware of
- The careful use of **rhetoric**, such as questioning or exclamations, can help to convince and persuade your intended audience
- Remember, you are required to consider and evaluate the ideas in the text(s) and use them to develop your own argument
- Ensure you keep to the suggested word limit:
 - Writing significantly under or over the suggested word count will affect your marks



Your notes

Persuasive Plan





Your notes

THINK

- This question is split between PURPOSE and FORM.
- The **purpose** of the paper is to persuade/argue/discuss. So remember the **Persuasive Writing Theory** (*ethos/pathos/logos*).
- The **form** will be a letter, article or speech. So remember those techniques.
- Analyse the question and actively read the insert, just as you would for the Paper 1 Reading exam.



FEEL

- Write down three words that sum up how you **feel** about the arguments presented in the text.



DO

- Write a quick table like this:

FOR	AGAINST

- **Find 5–6 arguments** from the text (4 For, 1 Against / 4 Against, 1 For – depending which side you’re arguing).
 - Sum them up into bullet-points and write them under the corresponding headers.
 - Remember to be aware of the counter-arguments, as that’s what you should start with.

- **Focusing only on your side of the argument**, label your bullets with the following argument type:
 - **E (emotional)**
 - **L (logical)**
 - **A (authoritative)**
 - This will make sure you have a varied and multi-faceted argument.



Examiner Tips and Tricks

- Don't waste time on writing long narratives in your plan – save that for your answer!

Stick to bullet-points, or a even just a single word to jog your memory. This plan is for YOUR benefit, not the examiner's.

Also, if you're unable to sum up your arguments, the examiner won't be able to either.



Your notes



Your notes

Question 1 Directed Writing: How to Write a Speech

Question 1 Directed Writing: How to Write a Speech

One of the three formats that you may be asked to write in for Question 1 is a speech. This may be to your class or students in your school or college, or something more formal intended for broadcast. The opinions and ideas you put forward in your speech should be based on what you have read in the reading passages given, and your writing marks will come from your ability to vary your writing to suit the purpose, audience and form of the task, as well as how you structure your response.

The following guide will detail how to structure your response in the style of a speech.

Key features of a speech

The language and tone of your speech will be determined by the task and subject, but the following are the basic features of a speech which you could include in your response:

Speech or talk
In a speech or talk you should: ▪ Address the audience directly throughout ▪ Engage the audience in your introduction: ▪ Outline the topic ▪ Use persuasive devices to hook the audience, such as rhetorical questions to get them thinking ▪ Structure your speech logically, building your arguments persuasively: ▪ Speeches or talks will use persuasive language features ▪ Use the acronym DAN FOREST PIE to remember these ▪ To offer a balanced view, include an objection to the argument in a separate paragraph ▪ Include your audience using inclusive pronouns (“we”, “us”, “our”) ▪ To finish, circle back to your original argument, calling your audience to action if appropriate

You might wish to structure your speech in the following way:

1. Directly address the reader or audience:

- Introduce the topic and your point of view



Your notes

- Use personal and inclusive pronouns to involve your audience, e.g., “you” or “we”
 - Engage your audience using a rhetorical question
2. Your next paragraph should develop your argument:
- You will need to infer information, ideas and opinions from the reading texts to do this
3. Provide an anecdote to offer an example which proves your argument:
- This builds rapport with your reader by engaging with them on a personal level
 - Again, this should be based on what you have read
4. Engage the reader on a personal level using a counter-argument:
- Again, this should be based on and developed from the ideas in the reading texts
5. Offer more research or studies:
- This can be in the form of statistics, a witness statement, poll, or quote from an expert, based on the reading texts
6. End your speech with an emotive plea:
- Use emotive language to engage your reader
 - Ending your response on a single sentence, perhaps using a triplet, is an effective conclusion



Examiner Tips and Tricks

Rhetorical questions are commonly used as a persuasive device, but avoid over-using any one technique, as this will make your writing sound much less sophisticated. Always consider the reason why you are using a technique and what the effect is that you want to achieve. Do not just use techniques for the sake of using them.

Persuasive writing

A speech is often more persuasive than other forms of writing. You are trying to persuade your audience that your point of view is valid, and sometimes encourage them to join you.

Here are some tips for how to make your speech persuasive:

- Write in the first person (write from your own perspective)
- Use personal and inclusive pronouns:
 - Using words such as “we” and “us” builds rapport between you and your audience and makes them feel involved



Your notes

- Present your opinions as facts; as a truth that should not be challenged
- Be passionate but not aggressive:
 - Use emotive language and imperatives to call your audience to action
- Decide on your position and stick to it
- Make sure you do not sound like an advertisement

As an example, let's consider the following introduction to a speech about GCSEs:

A triplet immediately draws attention to the main topic of the speech

Education, education, education. The importance of this word has been drilled into us since the age of four. We spend at least twelve of our childhood years going to school and working towards qualifications which, we are told, are essential if we want to get good jobs and be useful members of society. But how many employers actually care what grades we achieve in our GCSEs? Fellow students, I am here today to explain what I think really makes a good education.

A rhetorical question gives the audience something to consider

Direct address involves the audience and gets them on-side

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved

For more guidance, please see our [speech model answer](#).



Your notes

Question 1 Directed Writing: How to Write a Letter

Question 1 Directed Writing: How to Write a Letter

One of the three formats that you may be asked to write in for Question 1 is a letter. This may be an informal letter, to a friend or relative, or a formal one. You will be given the intended audience for your letter and the reason why you are writing in the task instructions. The arguments you put forward in your letter should be based on what you have read in the reading passages given, and your writing marks will come from your ability to vary your writing to suit the purpose, audience and form of the task, as well as how you structure your response.

The following guides will detail how to structure your response in the style of two different types of letter, an informal letter and a formal letter.

Informal letter

An informal letter will be written to someone you know well, such as a friend or a relative. You may be asked to offer your ideas and opinions as advice, or to weigh up the pros and cons of something. It is important to remember that, although you are writing to a relative or friend, this is an exam and you are not actually writing a letter to that person. Therefore, do not use abbreviations or slang, such as "OMG!".

Informal letter

In an informal letter you should:

- Start with "Dear" and use the first name of the person you are writing to
- Include a warm and friendly opening, such as:
 - *"It was good to hear from you," or "Sorry I have not replied sooner; I have been so busy revising for my exams."*
- Tell them why you are writing the letter:
 - The reason will be given to you in the task instructions
- Paragraphs should be clear and well sequenced, using appropriate connectives
- Use topic sentences to begin each paragraph, and then develop that point appropriately and in detail
- Do not try to include multiple, different arguments in one paragraph
- Use the bullet points in the task to structure your letter
- You can sign off your letter more informally:

- Try “Best wishes,” or “Hope to see you soon.”



Your notes

The level of informality in this style of letter comes from keeping your tone light and adding personal details. However, you still need to use accurate spelling, with a variety of sentences and punctuation used for effect.



Examiner Tips and Tricks

Always write with your intended audience in mind. Address them directly throughout your writing, mention their specific concerns and ensure you develop your points in a way which would convince your specific reader.

Formal letter

A formal letter will be written to somebody in authority, such as a headteacher, a manager or the editor of a newspaper. You will still be asked to put forward your point of view, ideas and opinions, based on what you have read in the text(s), but your tone and language should be adapted to suit the intended audience and purpose of writing. There are some typical conventions of a formal letter that you can use, but be careful not to spend too much time on irrelevant formatting details.

Formal letter

A formal letter should:

- Include a date
- Use the correct salutation:
 - If you *do not know the name* of the person you are writing to, then use “*Dear Sir/Madam*”
 - You can use “*Dear Editor*” if writing in response to an article or letter seen in a newspaper or magazine
- If you *do not know the name* of the person you are writing to, use “*Yours faithfully,*” at the end
- If you *are given the name* of the person, then start with “*Dear [name]*” and end with “*Yours sincerely,*”
- Your introduction should state what you are writing about, why you are writing and what your opinion is:
 - Make this relevant to the purpose of the task
 - Instead of using “*I am writing because...*”, use the wording of the task instructions

- For example: “I am writing to give my opinion about...”
- Paragraphs should be clear and well sequenced, using appropriate connectives
- Use topic sentences to begin each paragraph, and then develop that point appropriately and in detail
- Do not try to include multiple, different arguments in one paragraph



Your notes

A formal letter layout should look something like this:

	10 Edgware Road London W12 4PR
	4 June 2023
The Editor The Stanley Times 98 Waterside View London SE17AD	
Dear Editor,	
Introduction	
Main arguments	
Concluding paragraph	
Yours faithfully,	
Kathryn Thornley	

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved



Examiner Tips and Tricks

While writing in the correct form as instructed is important in this question, you only need to adhere to the basic conventions of a letter, article or speech. Spending too much time on perfecting the layout of the letter, or making up an address for the top of the letter, only detracts from your writing and will not gain you any extra marks. Remember, it is more important that you adapt your style, language and tone to suit the intended audience and purpose, and that you construct a well-structured and coherent piece of writing, than waste time on the layout of your response.

For more information about writing a letter in the exam, please see our [letter model answer](#).



Your notes



Your notes

Question 1 Directed Writing: How to Write an Article

Question 1 Directed Writing: How to Write an Article

One of the three formats that you may be asked to write in for Question 1 is an article. This will most likely be for a magazine, and you will be given the intended audience for your article and the reason why you are writing it in the task instructions. The opinions and ideas you put forward in your article should be based on what you have read in the reading passages given, and your writing marks will come from your ability to vary your writing to suit the purpose, audience and form of the task, as well as how you structure your response.

Key features of an article

The language and tone of your article will be determined by the task and subject, but the following are the basic features of an article which you could include in your response:

Magazine or newspaper article

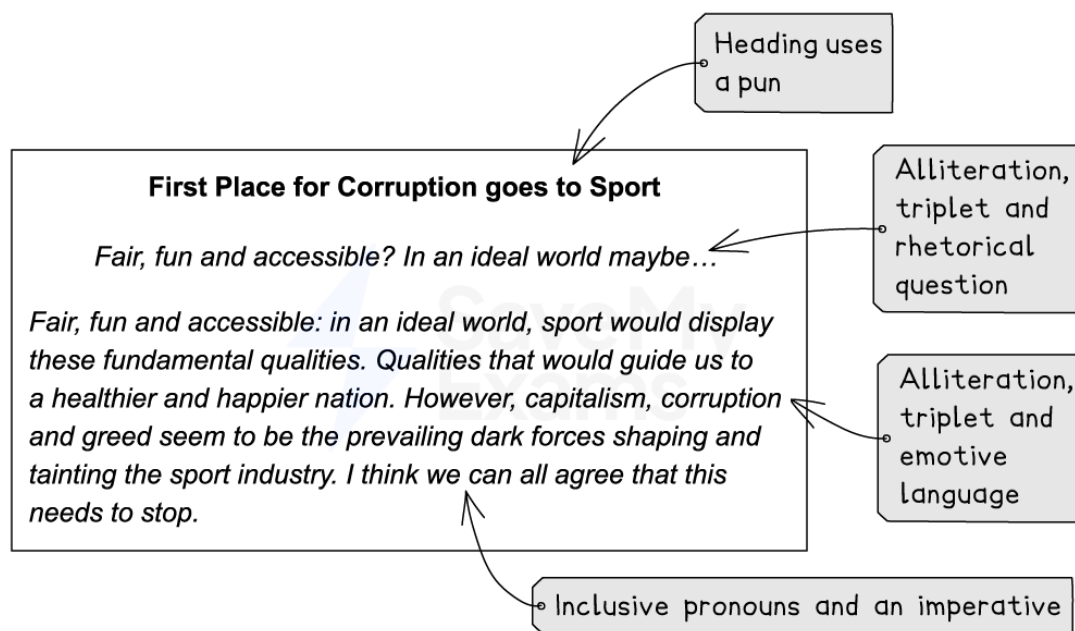
In an article you should:

- Use a snappy heading:
 - Consider using alliteration, a rhetorical question or a pun (a play on words) for this
 - Use capital letters for all but filler words in your heading
 - For example: *"The Cruelty of Captivity"*
- A strapline underneath the heading can summarise your point of view:
 - For example: *"Why keeping animals in captivity has fallen out of favour"*
- Use sub-headings to help structure your article (if appropriate)
- Address your audience directly, with consideration to the fact that an article is intended to be read by a wide audience
- Be light-hearted and entertaining, formal and serious, or provide advice and tips, depending on the task set
- Use topic sentences to begin each paragraph, and then develop that point appropriately and in detail
- Do not try to include multiple different arguments in one paragraph
- Avoid beginning your article with *"I'm writing this because..."* or *"In this article I shall be discussing..."*



Your notes

Because an article is intended for publication, it is important to use Standard English and to vary your sentence and paragraph lengths to keep your audience engaged. The heading, strapline and opening paragraph of an article can employ lots of persuasive devices to hook your reader and introduce your point of view. For example:



Examiner Tips and Tricks

Rhetorical questions are commonly used as headings, but they can be too simplistic or too general, so consider how you can make your headline sophisticated and specific. Choosing a simple statement can be very effective, using a play on words taken from the article topic.

Article structure

The ideas and opinions you put forward in your article will be based on what you have read in the text(s). However, your opinion can either be in favour of something, or against it, as long as you are able to sustain a convincing argument and a consistent point of view.

- Your article should be structured into five or six paragraphs:
 - Remember, each paragraph does not have to be the same length
 - Better answers vary the lengths of their paragraphs for effect

- Develop separate ideas or points in each paragraph
- But avoid repeating the same idea throughout your article

Remember that to produce an effective response, you should aim to develop your points carefully in each paragraph, using language features and techniques to highlight ideas and emphasise your points.



Examiner Tips and Tricks

While writing in the correct form as instructed is important in this question, you only need to adhere to the basic conventions of an article. Drawing columns or spending too much time thinking up the perfect headline wastes valuable time and will not improve your mark. Remember, it is more important that you adapt your style, language and tone to suit the intended audience and purpose, and that you construct a well-structured and coherent piece of writing, than waste time on the layout of your response.

For more guidance, please see our [article model answer](#).



Your notes



Your notes

Question 1 Directed Writing Skills: SPaG

Question 1 Directed Writing Skills: SPaG

As you are mainly being assessed on your writing skills, Assessment Objective W5 tests you on your ability to make accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar. One of the key things the examiners look for is the use of a range of different sentence forms in your writing, which will naturally lead to a greater range of punctuation which the examiners can then reward. However, getting the basics right and consistency are key. Leaving five minutes to proof-read your work when you have finished writing is therefore really important, as it is easy to make silly mistakes in the pressure of an exam situation.



Examiner Tips and Tricks

Ensure you are careful to use basic end-of-sentence punctuation correctly. A common error is the use of commas instead of full-stops. This is called comma-splicing and should be avoided. A comma represents the separation of two or more parts of a sentence, not a break at the end of a sentence.

Sentence demarcation

Sentence demarcation means that you have started your sentences with a capital letter and ended them correctly, using either a full stop, question mark or exclamation mark. This sounds simple enough, but comma-splicing and run-on sentences are some of the most common errors made in terms of technical accuracy in the exam, so it is important to review that you know exactly when a sentence finishes and how to indicate that it has finished.

Sentences end with three types of punctuation:

- A full stop (for a statement)
- A question mark (for a direct question)
- An exclamation mark (to indicate surprise, shock, anger or happiness)

All sentences must begin with a capital letter.

Have a look at the example below. Sentence demarcation is absent, so consider how much harder it is to make sense of what has been written:

Whether or not you think smartphones are a good thing, the fact of life in today's society is that the mobile phone is no longer just a phone in fact they are our lives we network, socialize, gossip and get information from them, we have our bus passes, train tickets, bank cards, timetables and reminders

on them we can even do our college work on them what we use them for is constantly changing and expanding.



Your notes

Now compare the example above with the example below, which uses the correct sentence demarcations:

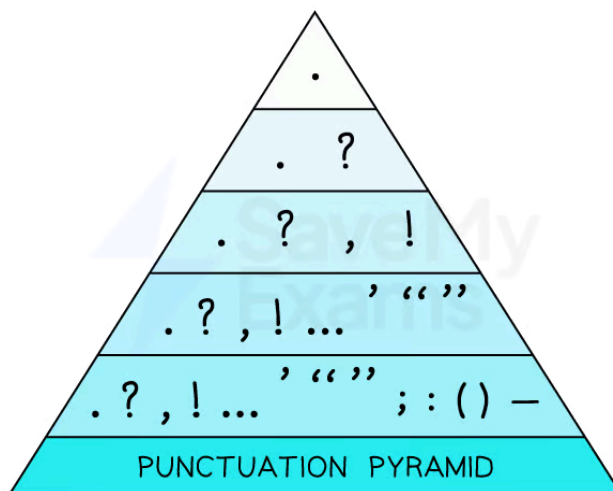
Whether or not you think smartphones are a good thing, the fact of life in today's society is that the mobile phone is no longer just a phone. In fact, they are our lives. We network, socialise, gossip and get information from them. We have our bus passes, train tickets, bank cards, timetables and reminders on them. We can even do our college work on them. What we use them for is constantly changing and expanding.

The more sophisticated and complex your sentences, the more important accurate sentence demarcation is. Varying the length of your sentences will create a more dynamic rhythm to your writing.

Range of punctuation

For the highest marks, you need to use a wide range of punctuation accurately and purposefully to achieve specific effects. This means that you make conscious choices about the type of punctuation you are using in your writing, and why you are using it. However, it is worth remembering that using apostrophes, semi-colons and colons accurately just a few times is preferable to using them indiscriminately and incorrectly. It is also very important to know how to punctuate dialogue accurately if you choose to use it in a piece of creative writing; if you are not sure of the rules of punctuating direct speech, then avoid it!

The bottom tier of the punctuation pyramid below shows the range of punctuation you should be aiming to use:



Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved



Your notes

Below you will find a brief explanation of colons and semi-colons and their uses:

Colons:

Colons can introduce lists, quotes or long explanations. They can be used in an article, for example, to introduce a list of tips if you are giving advice. They can also be used before a direct quote (one you may have made up from an "expert").

For example:

The media officer for London Zoo advised: "We take the protection and welfare of our animals extremely seriously. Any reported concerns regarding the health of our animals would be acted upon immediately."

Semicolons:

Semicolons can be used to connect two related sentences instead of a full stop or a conjunction. They are therefore a good way of adding variety to your writing.

For example:

Most celebrities in today's culture do very little except promote themselves tirelessly; they do no actual work and rely on social media to do the work for them.

They can also be used instead of commas when separating items in a very long or wordy list.

Range of sentence forms

Using a range of sentence forms means that you deliberately consider how your sentences create a tone of voice. For example, short sentences can indicate tension or urgency, especially if they are written in the imperative form. Long, complex sentences can sound quite formal, but too many of them can be monotonous and difficult to read.

Below you will find some of the ways you can vary your sentences:

Type of sentence	Explanation
Sentence openers	This means varying how you start your sentences, avoiding starting each one with personal pronouns ("I") or with the same word
	Instead, you could start your sentences with: ▪ An adverb, e.g., "Suddenly", "Quietly" ▪ A preposition, e.g., "In the distance", "Over the hill" ▪ A verb, e.g., "Having had many years of experience in this field, I..."



Your notes

	▪ A double adjective, e.g., “Strong and powerful,…” ▪ A connective, e.g., “Furthermore”, “Additionally”
Sentence length	Try to vary the length of your sentences, as too many long sentences can overshadow your arguments, whereas using too many short sentences sounds simple and can make your arguments stunted
	In general, if your paragraph consists of only one or two long sentences, you need to revisit it to consider how easy it is for your reader to identify your main points and the purpose of the paragraph
	Alternating between sentence lengths allows writers to use sentences strategically, emphasising important points through short sentences and providing detail with longer ones
	For example: <i>The oil company reported that their profits had risen by more than 10% over the period of half a year. This information shocked the public. How, in a period of financial difficulty for the entire nation, could a single company justify raising prices and lining their pockets while ordinary people suffered?</i>
Sentence type	There are four main types of sentences:
	Simple: a simple sentence is a single clause with no conjunction or dependent clause
	Compound: a compound sentence is two independent clauses joined by a conjunction (“and”, “because”, “but”, “so”)
	Complex: a complex sentence contains one main clause and at least one dependent clause (which relies on the main clause for meaning)
	Compound-complex: a compound-complex sentence contains multiple independent clauses and at least one dependent clause
	Understanding sentence types will help you avoid repetition and monotony in your writing

Standard English and secure grammar



Your notes

Standard English is accepted as the “correct” form of English, used in formal writing. It follows grammatical rules such as subject-verb agreement and the correct use of verb tenses. Non-standard English often contains slang and is used in more informal situations. This does not mean that you cannot use colloquial language in your writing, especially in an article or speech, but this will be determined by the task and topic.

It is worth noting that mistakes with sentence agreement (subject-verb agreement) and the inconsistent use of tense are frequently flagged by examiners as being an issue in exams. Therefore, it is important that you:

- Use plurals correctly
- Maintain a consistent use of tense:
 - If you are writing in the past tense, ensure that this is consistent throughout your writing
 - If you do change from past to present tense, it should be done purposefully and for effect
- Ensure you are using apostrophes correctly, especially to show possession



Examiner Tips and Tricks

Remember, the best answers use a variety of sentence structures and punctuation features, which have been skilfully used to construct a tone of voice relevant to the task. Using ambitious and sophisticated vocabulary often separates lower-mark responses from ones getting high marks. However, your use of ambitious vocabulary should be appropriate and precise; do not use a more sophisticated word just because you think it “sounds” better, especially if you are not 100% sure of its meaning.



Your notes

Question 1 Model Answer: Speech

Question 1 Model Answer: Speech

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on the opinions, ideas and information you are presented with in one or two reading passages. You may be asked to write in one of three possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A speech
- An article

The following guide will demonstrate how to answer Question 1 in the format of a **speech**. The task itself is taken from a past exam paper.

Addressing the reading assessment objectives

Up to 15 marks are available in this task for your ability to evaluate both the explicit and implied ideas, opinions and attitudes expressed in one or two texts, and assimilate them to write a developed and sophisticated response.

Let's take a look at how you do this, using the following Question 1 example:

Question 1

Imagine you are a pupil in a school which does not have a school council.

Write a speech to be given in a school assembly, giving your views on whether or not students should participate in decisions made about the school.

In your speech you should:

- evaluate the views given in both texts about student participation
- give your own views, based on what you have read, about whether a school council would benefit students and teachers.

Base your speech on what you have read in **both** texts, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

Begin your speech: 'Thank you for coming to listen to me today ...'.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Your response here has to be based on the ideas, opinions and attitudes contained in the following two texts:



Your notes

Text A

The following passage is an article from a local newspaper about a school in the area and the future of its school council.

Student representation: Do we really care what students think?

The once fashionable idea of giving students a say in how their schools are run is being challenged by a recently appointed head teacher as 'mere lip service to student participation.' As is now common in many schools, students in Mr Aziz's school elect representatives from each year group to attend meetings and discuss their concerns with the school authorities. But Mr Aziz believes that these school councils do more harm than good, draining students' and teachers' energies on a fake body whose decisions do not, and should not, influence children's education. 'The misguided belief that young people should be able to limit the actions of experienced educators is simply wrong,' he says. 'We're accountable to their parents to give them the best education: we cannot waste their time and ours consulting them at every stage about issues which they don't understand.'

One pupil, Sofia, who campaigned enthusiastically over a whole term for the votes of her Year 11 classmates last year, gave Mr Aziz some unexpected support. 'The school council meets every now and then to give the impression that students have a say, but nothing ever happens. We spent ages working on a report about improvements we wanted to see in the school – sensible things like more gym equipment and a wider curriculum. The teachers listened politely but the report was ignored. In class our teachers were even irritated that our homework was late because of all the planning involved!' Sofia's dad also had misgivings. 'We selected this school for its solid academic record. My daughter's here to learn – and I'm paying a lot for that,' he adds wryly.

Mr Aziz says it makes sense to be concerned about individual students' worries and ideas and his door is always open to those who are unhappy about any aspect of school life. 'And I encourage teachers to listen to their students and pass on any concerns to me,' he said. 'But one pupil told me the older representatives on the school council should even be consulted on teacher appointments! I have twenty years' experience to ensure that students leave my school with good academic results and the skills to become useful adults. Student representatives can't and shouldn't interfere with that.'



Your notes

Text B

The following passage is taken from a guide for teachers about setting up school councils.

There's a transformation taking place for thousands of school students all over the country and it's thanks to their enlightened approach to student participation. This Guide contains some good examples of including children and young people in decision-making. We have also included some simple pointers of what makes an effective school council.

Recent research has shown that if a school places the involvement of their students at the heart of everything they do, the benefits and opportunities for them, and for the school, are significantly increased. But it takes real commitment, not just lip service. Young people are very astute. They will quickly identify a lack of commitment and if they do, they will soon become disillusioned. Set out clear aims, explaining what participation is, why it's important, and how to get involved. State clearly what you're prepared to commit and what you expect from them. 5
10

The most effective participation is when pupils have a say on the 'real' issues that affect their school. For example, invite them to help shape key policies for the future. Empower them with the responsibility of helping to regulate behaviour, bullying or the environment. Give them the opportunity to influence the development of the curriculum or new teaching initiatives. Give children and young people the chance to make a difference and you'll see the difference ... in their attitude to school, to learning, to their teachers and to their peers. 15

Talk to anyone associated with a school that has a strong student participation policy and they are unanimous in the belief that empowering children and young people in this way has changed school life for the better. Behaviour, attendance and results can improve because more children and young people acquire the self-esteem that comes from improved communication, negotiation and decision-making skills. Children and young people can provide a fresh, new perspective. They see things differently and, because any decision will directly impact on their lives, they often have very clear views and opinions. 20

After carefully reading the task, you should read the texts and highlight the ideas and opinions that could inform your writing. Your response might use the following ideas from these texts:

Text A:

- Student representation was "once fashionable", but it may just be a passing fad
- School councils take up too much time and energy from schools and teachers when they have more important things to be getting on with
- If student representation is fake or just to tick a box, then it has no substance, especially if views and ideas are not acted upon
- Teachers are accountable to parents and should put education first
- Even some students are disillusioned with the idea of student representation when nothing is acted upon, especially given the time and effort involved

- Experienced teachers should make decisions, not children – trust should be placed in the people appointed to run the school and deliver the education

Text B:

- An “enlightened” approach is needed to make school councils work and it takes real commitment
- Student participation is very popular and well regarded
- Student participation works when children are involved in “real” issues
- Students can take responsibility for difficult problems such as behaviour or bullying
- Participation can make a difference to students’ attitudes to school
- Attendance and results are improved by participation
- Students can learn important skills such as negotiation, communication and decision-making
- Students can have a fresh eye on issues
- Decisions made may have a major impact on them, so students are motivated to participate



Your notes

Planning your response

Once you have read the text(s), identified relevant opinions, ideas and attitudes and bullet-pointed these in your own words, you should then spend five minutes planning your written response. In your plan:

- Decide on your “voice” and point of view
- Write a statement that summarises your point of view, based on your reading
- Note down which points you can develop that support your point of view in your first paragraph
- Decide whether you are going to make a counter-argument, and note down which points you can develop to support this
- Return to your main argument, ensuring that you have included ideas and opinions from both texts (if more than one)
- Note down the points you can make to address the second bullet point in the task
- Note down how you are going to start and finish your response, ensuring that it establishes the correct style and tone

Speech model answer

The following model answer demonstrates a top-mark response to the above task:



Your notes

Thank you for coming to listen to me today on the topic of whether students should participate in decisions made about our school. As you are aware, we currently do not have a school council, which I personally believe is short-sighted and denies us the opportunity to develop important life skills.

Student participation in school decisions, such as via a school council, can be a divisive topic, and a lot of the time the effectiveness of a school council is dependent on the type of school you go to and how well student participation is managed. A school with a council in which students' feedback and decisions are not valued is indeed pointless. If student representatives are in a meeting in order just to tick a box, then this has no substance. If I was a student representative and I put a lot of time and effort into preparing for a council meeting, only to have my views and the views of my fellow students ignored, then this would leave me feeling disillusioned and unheard. In these cases, student and teacher time would be better spent on actual teaching and learning.

The speech starts as instructed and demonstrates an understanding of the task and the purpose

The introduction establishes a clear voice and point of view

Ideas and opinions from Text A are implied in the response

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved



Your notes

I can also imagine that, in fee-paying schools, parents would expect their children and the teachers to put education first, and leave the big decisions to those entrusted with running the school in the first place. However, we are not in a fee-paying school, and in addition, not having a school council implies a lack of belief in our ability to make informed decisions about the place where we currently spend the majority of our time. Just because we are young, this does not mean that we are incapable of making good decisions and providing good feedback.

Having a school council or some other form of student representation can bring real benefits to a school and its pupils. Students can feel valued, and at the same time develop life skills such as communication, negotiation and decision-making. Being a member of a school council is well-regarded and looks good when it comes to college, university or job interviews, and students can offer a fresh perspective on issues that can be challenging to solve, such as behaviour and bullying. When students are given more responsibility, this can result in more positive attitudes, better attendance and results. Given this trust, we would be more motivated to participate in decisions that have a major impact on our lives.

The response uses conventions of a speech, such as inclusive pronouns and direct address to connect to the audience

The response goes on to incorporate ideas from Text B

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved



Your notes

As part of my preparation for this speech, I read a guide for teachers on setting up school councils, and while some ambitious claims were made about their benefits, I wonder how realistic the guide is when considering the amount of time and commitment a school council requires from both students and teachers. The guide only promoted the benefits, and while I believe that we do need student representation in this school, I do think it has to be balanced and well-considered. I think the most effective type of participation is one in which pupils have a say on the real issues that affect our school, and where we have the opportunity to shape key policies for the future. This enlightened approach, however, should not just be rushed into. For this to work in our school it will take real commitment, with real benefits attached for both students and teachers alike. Ultimately, I believe that we should be trusted with the responsibility in shaping the course of our own education, and a school council would be one of the ways in which we can do this.

Thank you for listening.

The argument is sustained throughout

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved

Unannotated model answer

Thank you for coming to listen to me today on the topic of whether students should participate in decisions made about our school. As you are aware, we currently do not have a school council, which I personally believe is short-sighted and denies us the opportunity to develop important life skills.

Student participation in school decisions, such as via a school council, can be a divisive topic, and a lot of the time the effectiveness of a school council is dependent on the type of school you go to and how well student participation is managed. A school with a council in which students' feedback and decisions are not valued is indeed pointless. If student representatives are in a meeting in order just to tick a box, then this has no substance. If I was a student representative and I put a lot of time and effort into preparing for a council meeting, only to have my views and the views of my fellow students ignored, then this would leave me feeling disillusioned and unheard. In these cases, student and teacher time would be better spent on actual teaching and learning.

I can also imagine that, in fee-paying schools, parents would expect their children and the teachers to



Your notes

put education first, and leave the big decisions to those entrusted with running the school in the first place. However, we are not in a fee-paying school, and in addition, not having a school council implies a lack of belief in our ability to make informed decisions about the place where we currently spend the majority of our time. Just because we are young, this does not mean that we are incapable of making good decisions and providing good feedback.

Having a school council or some other form of student representation can bring real benefits to a school and its pupils. Students can feel valued, and at the same time develop life skills such as communication, negotiation and decision-making. Being a member of a school council is well-regarded and looks good when it comes to college, university or job interviews, and students can offer a fresh perspective on issues that can be challenging to solve, such as behaviour and bullying. When students are given more responsibility, this can result in more positive attitudes, better attendance and results. Given this trust, we would be more motivated to participate in decisions that have a major impact on our lives.

As part of my preparation for this speech, I read a guide for teachers on setting up school councils, and while some ambitious claims were made about their benefits, I wonder how realistic the guide is when considering the amount of time and commitment a school council requires from both students and teachers. The guide only promoted the benefits, and while I believe that we do need student representation in this school, I do think it has to be balanced and well-considered. I think the most effective type of participation is one in which pupils have a say on the real issues that affect our school, and where we have the opportunity to shape key policies for the future. This enlightened approach, however, should not just be rushed into. For this to work in our school it will take real commitment, with real benefits attached for both students and teachers alike. Ultimately, I believe that we should be trusted with the responsibility in shaping the course of our own education, and a school council would be one of the ways in which we can do this.

Thank you for listening.

Commentary:

- The speech starts as instructed and demonstrates an understanding of the task, its purpose and intended audience
- The introduction establishes a clear voice and point of view
- Ideas and opinions from both texts are implied in the response
- The response uses conventions of a speech, such as inclusive pronouns and direct address, to connect to the audience
- The argument is sustained throughout
- Spelling, grammar and punctuation are accurate





Your notes

Examiner Tips and Tricks

The suggested word count for this task is a guide, and you are not penalised for writing under or over 250–350 words. However, writing too little can mean that your answer does not have enough development or detail. Writing too much can mean that you go off topic and lose focus, which again can be self-penalising. It is therefore a good idea to stick as closely as you can to the word count guidance.

Our model answers are not written in timed, exam conditions. We have therefore shown a range of points that could be included to answer this question, and provided a model you can use to help with the structure of your answer.

You can find further guidance on suggested word counts for CIE [here](#).

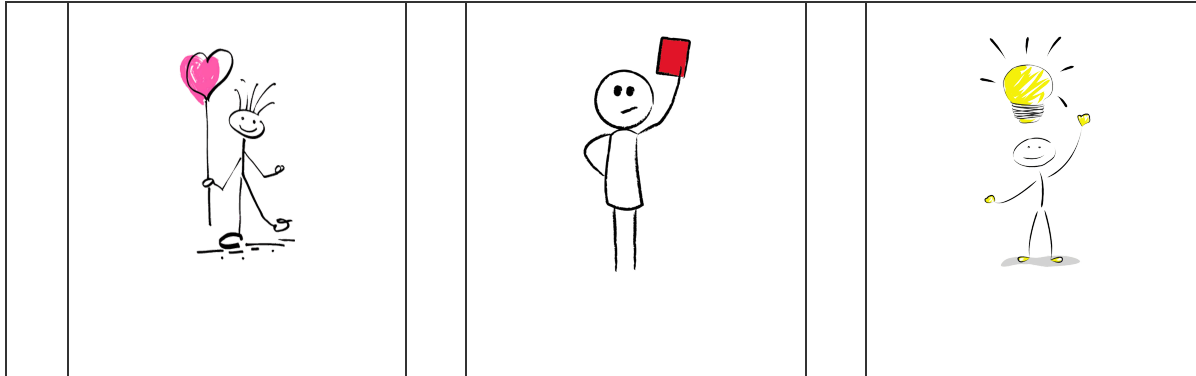
Summary

- Remember to read the question carefully and highlight:
 - What you are writing, who your audience is and why you are writing
 - The focus of each bullet point
- Read the text(s) and highlight the relevant information that could be developed in your answer
- Bullet-point this information in your own words
- Plan your writing, focusing on one main idea or opinion per paragraph
- Address each bullet point in order:
 - Make sure you cover all of the bullet points as equally as possible
- Decide on the voice and style you want to create and maintain that in your answer
- Do not just repeat details from the text(s):
 - You need to evaluate and develop the ideas, opinions and attitudes in the text(s) – you are not summarising them

Persuasive Theory



Your notes



Emotional (<i>Pathos</i>)	Authoritative (<i>Ethos</i>)	Logical (<i>Logos</i>)
Argument based on emotions and beliefs	Argument based on trust and authority	Argument based on facts and reason



Your notes

Question 1 Model Answer: Letter

Question 1 Model Answer: Letter

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on the opinions, ideas and information you are presented with in one or two reading passages. You may be asked to write in one of three possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A speech
- An article

The following guide will demonstrate how to answer Question 1 in the format of a **letter**. The task itself is taken from a past exam paper.

Addressing the reading assessment objectives

Up to 15 marks are available in this task for your ability to evaluate both the explicit and implied ideas, opinions and attitudes expressed in one or two texts, and assimilate them to write a developed and sophisticated response.

Let's take a look at how you do this, using the following Question 1 example:

Question 1

A relative is considering moving to another country where they and their teenage children will have to learn a new language.

Write a letter to your relative giving your views about whether or not this is a good idea.

In your letter you should:

- evaluate the ideas, opinions and attitudes in both texts
- explain how successful you think the move will be for the adults and their children.

Base your letter on what you have read in **both** texts, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

Your response here has to be based on the ideas, opinions and attitudes contained in the following two texts:



Your notes

Text A: The joys of bilingualism

The following text, written by a parent, is about being able to speak more than one language.

Everyone knows that it's intriguing to watch your children change over the years. But to hear them alter their language, over the course of a few weeks, is almost surreal. Until we moved to their mother's country, Italy, my children had always lived in England and their English was what you would expect: fluent and full of pre-teen playground slang.

What's breathtaking since we moved isn't just their language acquisition, it's the way their personalities subtly shift. Our eldest daughter, abrupt at the best of times, is strangely sweet in Italian; the middle child, our funny girl in English, is precise and serious; and the youngest is even more boisterous in Italian. 5

I, too, feel altered. If you're a writer, and words are your currency, hopefully you're eloquent. But when you live in a language not your own, however fluent you are, your accent is ever obvious and you lack the nuances. Humour is hard. In a language as melodious as Italian, you will always be blunt. The children, though, will hopefully become what I can never be: truly bilingual. 10

Until recently, bilingualism was considered damaging to a child's development. If, for example, immigrants maintained a mother tongue at home, it would impede integration at school and probably lead to academic regression. These ideas changed with growing research on the brains and behaviour of bilingual children leading some to believe that bilingualism may offer some advantages. 15

Research also suggests that being bilingual increases your ability to empathise, to see a situation from another's perspective and there's some evidence that bilingual people develop dementia later than monolinguals. A flexibility of mind makes multi-tasking less problematic for bilinguals, apparently. 20

It would be very easy to become smug, but there are clear drawbacks as well as advantages. The verbal aptitude of bilinguals in each language is generally less than that of monolingual speakers; the vocabulary size is smaller and there is a slower response time for understanding and producing words. 25

It's as if some bilinguals can speak, say, 95 per cent of two languages, rather than a 100 per cent of one. If children are to be articulate and sophisticated language users, that missing 5 per cent is a major hole, especially if you want them fully to appreciate the culture of both. And people lose old languages, or don't gain new ones, for reasons that have nothing to do with a careful measurement of potential benefits. 30

In another language, you don't just learn new words, or sounds, but new notions. It's like putting on different spectacles and seeing the world with different eyes. You gain a different perspective and sometimes, if you're lucky, you become more, rather than less, eloquent.



Your notes

Text B

The following text is about being bilingual.

Being able to switch between two or more languages in conversation is pretty cool. This week a study from the University of Washington found that bilingual babies will have developed 'better' brains before they even utter a first word. But it's not all brain development and top grades.

It's true people will find you cultured, worldly and intelligent, even though you probably didn't have a choice about learning an extra language. You either picked it up as a baby or you were forced to learn it when you moved to another country. But bilingual people are rarely equally proficient in both languages and it's easy to make mistakes in one language or the other. It takes real effort to keep both if you don't use them equally. Many people lose one of their languages over time. 5

An extra language makes you more marketable for employers since the 21st century world is a globalised economy. If employees can speak another language they can interact with more of the world, provided they have the range of vocabulary and fluency for a professional setting. Some bilinguals have been educated in a language they don't speak outside of school or college. They might be fluent there but not so much in the big, wide world. 10

Your first language can keep you in touch with your roots wherever you go, through books or through music. Although I moved to the UK when I was 10 and absorbed much of the surrounding culture, I'll never forget where I'm from since my mother frequently likes to remind me of proverbs that really don't make much sense in English. 15

Apparently, those who speak different languages can experience personality changes when switching from one to another. That explains why my friends say I sound angry when I'm on the phone to my parents! 20

After carefully reading the task, you should read the texts and highlight the ideas and opinions that could inform your writing. Your response might use the following ideas from these texts:

Text A:

- "Pre-teens" pick up a new language quickly
- New languages can change young people's personalities
- Picking up on nuance and being able to express humour in a new language is hard
- Arguably, true bilingualism is not possible
- Accents are always obvious
- Attitudes to bilingualism have changed with research
- Bilingualism can help with empathy and help people to see different perspectives
- There is some evidence that bilingualism could protect against dementia and makes our minds more flexible

- But it can make people less articulate/developed in both languages
- Bilingualism can be very enriching and help you to become more eloquent

Text B:

- Gaining a second language is not always a choice
- It can make you a more interesting person
- Bilingual people are rarely equally proficient in both languages and it is easy to make mistakes
- Languages can be lost without effort
- Being able to speak an extra language can make you more employable
- It is not always possible to be fluent in more than one context
- Retaining your first language helps you keep your link to your culture
- Switching from one language to another can lead to personality changes



Your notes

Planning your response

Once you have read the text(s), identified relevant opinions, ideas and attitudes and bullet-pointed these in your own words, you should then spend five minutes planning your written response. When planning:

- Decide on your “voice” and point of view
- Write a statement that summarises your point of view, based on your reading
- Note down which points you can develop that support your point of view in your first paragraph
- Decide if you are going to make a counter-argument, and note down which points you can develop to support this
- Return to your main argument, ensuring that you have included ideas and opinions from both texts (if more than one)
- Note down the points you can make to address the second bullet point in the task
- Note down how you are going to start and finish your response, ensuring that it establishes the correct style and tone

Letter model answer

The following model answer demonstrates a top-mark response to the above task:



Your notes

The greeting and tone are appropriate for a letter to a relative

Dear Auntie Ruth,

It was good to hear from you, and thank you for asking for my advice about your possible move to France! Although I'll miss Luke and Harry, it will be an exciting adventure for them if you decide to go. I'm sure that it will definitely have challenges for them though, as well as for you and Uncle Ali.

The introduction demonstrates an understanding of the purpose of the task

I've done a bit of research on this, especially about the impact of having to learn a new language and integrate into a new culture. I think becoming fluent in a new language is harder the older you are, and given that Luke and Harry are now both teenagers, they might struggle with integrating into their new school, especially if they stand out because of their accents. I would hate for them to feel isolated, and they might feel as though they cannot properly express themselves while they are learning French. This also applies to you, especially if you both also have new jobs to become used to. Things like tone and humour can be really difficult to master, and this might lead to confusion and misunderstandings. It also might be that they learn faster than you, so this could lead to distance between you all.

This paragraph develops ideas and opinions mainly from Text A, and establishes a point of view

Although the letter is informal, the vocabulary is sophisticated

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved



Your notes

This paragraph acknowledges a counter argument, using ideas from both texts

I think there is no doubt that being able to communicate in more than one language definitely has its benefits. I would imagine that it can help us see the world from different perspectives, and being able to speak a second language well would be a really great employability skill, especially for Luke and Harry, if they are able to switch the contexts in which they are able to communicate fluently. Flexing your brains to learn a second language would also be good for you in the future; in fact, I think I read that being bilingual can help prevent dementia later in life.

This paragraph returns to the main argument, using ideas mainly from Text B

However, for most people, becoming bilingual is not necessarily a choice, and that can make it harder. I think bilingual people are not often completely proficient in both languages, and therefore it is easy to make mistakes. Again, this might make you all feel more isolated or that you don't completely fit in. More importantly for you, though, is that you might lose your links with your culture and way of life here. Even our first language can be lost if we are not speaking it regularly, so while you may think that being able to speak more than one language might make you more interesting, this might be at the expense of what makes you, you!

Punctuation is used deliberately to emphasise the more friendly tone

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved



Your notes

This paragraph explicitly addresses the second bullet point in the task

If you do decide to go, I hope the move will be successful for you all, but I am concerned that there will be more implications than just the actual process of learning a second language. It is amazing to go on a new adventure and experience life in another country, but this may lead to arguments and frustrations between you all. I know you will all give it 100 percent, but trying to learn to communicate fluently in French may result in you all being actually less articulate in both languages. If Luke and Harry had been younger, then they might have been able to adapt more quickly, but given their ages and the fact that learning new languages can change people's personalities, I do not think this will be a good move for you all.

Persuasive devices are used to add weight to the argument

Whatever you decide, however, I wish you all the best!

Hope to speak to you soon,

Nadia

Style and tone are maintained throughout, with an appropriate sign off

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved

Unannotated model answer

Dear Auntie Ruth,

It was good to hear from you, and thank you for asking for my advice about your possible move to France! Although I'll miss Luke and Harry, it will be an exciting adventure for them if you decide to go. I'm sure that it will definitely have challenges for them though, as well as for you and Uncle Ali.

I've done a bit of research on this, especially about the impact of having to learn a new language and integrate into a new culture. I think becoming fluent in a new language is harder the older you are, and given that Luke and Harry are now both teenagers, they might struggle with integrating into their new school, especially if they stand out because of their accents. I would hate for them to feel isolated, and



Your notes

they might feel as though they cannot properly express themselves while they are learning French. This also applies to you, especially if you both also have new jobs to become used to. Things like tone and humour can be really difficult to master, and this might lead to confusion and misunderstandings. It also might be that they learn faster than you, so this could lead to distance between you all.

I think there is no doubt that being able to communicate in more than one language definitely has its benefits. I would imagine that it can help us see the world from different perspectives, and being able to speak a second language well would be a really great employability skill, especially for Luke and Harry, if they are able to switch the contexts in which they are able to communicate fluently. Flexing your brains to learn a second language would also be good for you in the future; in fact, I think I read that being bilingual can help prevent dementia later in life.

However, for most people, becoming bilingual is not necessarily a choice, and that can make it harder. I think bilingual people are not often completely proficient in both languages, and therefore it is easy to make mistakes. Again, this might make you all feel more isolated or that you don't completely fit in. More importantly for you, though, is that you might lose your links with your culture and way of life here. Even our first language can be lost if we are not speaking it regularly, so while you may think that being able to speak more than one language might make you more interesting, this might be at the expense of what makes you, you!

If you do decide to go, I hope the move will be successful for you all, but I am concerned that there will be more implications than just the actual process of learning a second language. It is amazing to go on a new adventure and experience life in another country, but this may lead to arguments and frustrations between you all. I know you will all give it 100 percent, but trying to learn to communicate fluently in French may result in you all being actually less articulate in both languages. If Luke and Harry had been younger, then they might have been able to adapt more quickly, but given their ages and the fact that learning new languages can change people's personalities, I do not think this will be a good move for you all.

Whatever you decide, however, I wish you all the best!

Hope to speak to you soon,

Nadia

Commentary:

- The greeting and tone are appropriate for a letter to a relative
- The introduction demonstrates an understanding of the purpose of the task
- The second paragraph develops ideas and opinions mainly from Text A, and establishes a point of view
- Although the letter is informal, the vocabulary is sophisticated
- The third paragraph acknowledges a counter-argument, using ideas from both texts
- The fourth paragraph returns to the main argument, using ideas mainly from Text B



Your notes

- Punctuation is used deliberately to emphasise the more friendly tone
- The final paragraph explicitly addresses the second bullet point in the task
- Persuasive devices are used to add weight to the argument
- Style and tone are maintained throughout, with an appropriate sign off
- Spelling, grammar and punctuation are accurate throughout



Examiner Tips and Tricks

The suggested word count for this task is a guide, and you are not penalised for writing under or over 250–350 words. However, writing too little can mean that your answer does not have enough development or detail. Writing too much can mean that you go off topic and lose focus, which again can be self-penalising. It is therefore a good idea to stick as closely as you can to the word count guidance.

Our model answers are not written in timed, exam conditions. We have therefore shown a range of points that could be included to answer this question, and provided a model you can use to help with the structure of your answer.

You can find further guidance on suggested word counts for CIE [here](#).

Summary

- Remember to read the question carefully and highlight:
 - What you are writing, who you are writing to and why you are writing
 - The focus of each bullet point
- Read the text(s) and highlight the relevant information that could be developed in your answer
- Bullet-point this information in your own words
- Plan your writing, focusing on one main idea or opinion per paragraph
- Address each bullet point in order:
 - Make sure you cover all of the bullet points as equally as possible
- Decide on the voice and style you want to create and maintain that in your answer
- Do not just repeat details from the text(s):
 - You need to evaluate and develop the ideas, opinions and attitudes in the text(s) – you are not summarising them



Your notes

Question 1 Model Answer: Article

Question 1 Model Answer: Article

For this task, you will be asked to produce a piece of writing in a particular format, based on the opinions, ideas and information you are presented with in one or two reading passages. You may be asked to write in one of three possible formats (genres):

- A letter
- A speech
- An article

The following guide will demonstrate how to answer Question 1 in the format of an **article**. The task itself is taken from a past exam paper.

Addressing the reading assessment objectives

Up to 15 marks are available in this task for your ability to evaluate both the explicit and implied ideas, opinions and attitudes expressed in one or two texts, and assimilate them to write a developed and sophisticated response.

Let's take a look at how you do this, using the following Question 1 example:

Question 1

Write a magazine article for young people about modern friendship.

In your article you should:

- evaluate the ideas about friendship given in both texts
- explain, based on what you read, to what extent you think social media affects friendship.

Base your article on what you have read in **both** texts, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

Your response here has to be based on the ideas, opinions and attitudes contained in the following two texts:



Your notes

Text A: My best friendships happen online but that doesn't make them any less valid

The following text is about online friendships.

We blame the internet for all human sins. It has grown popular to berate the internet for its role in our ever-growing loneliness epidemic.

Scientists regularly release studies that suggest a correlation between social media use and loneliness, low self-esteem and social isolation. But even they have to admit we do not know what came first: the loneliness or the social media.

5

I'd like to defend the internet. I've just spent a year researching friendship for my book, which is about precisely this: the intersection between loneliness and friendship.

I've spoken to countless people, both my own friends and strangers from the internet, who would simply not have access to the same social life without social media. I know a woman who met all three of her bridesmaids – the women she cherishes most in the world – online. She says she feels like her most authentic self when she's online.

10

This is perhaps exactly the point: we can no longer quite so easily distinguish between our online selves and our 'real' selves. We are becoming confident enough to merge our online and offline selves as we realise that social media is an important platform for friendship.

My best friends in the world live in Melbourne, New York, Los Angeles and New Orleans. I am, at any time, a minimum of 5 000 kilometres away from them. Catch-ups over lunch are not possible for us. Our group chat has become a glorious mishmash of the trivial and the meaningful – home to career advice, dog pictures, memes and moral support. I am indignant and distressed by anyone who would suggest our largely online friendship is in any way less valid than people who have the luxury of sharing oxygen in the same physical place.

15

20

Besides, befriending apps are popping up all over. Some alleviate the loneliness for new mums or help you find new friends when you move to a new city. The clever thing about so many of these apps is they use the very thing we blame for our disconnection from others – technology – to bring us back together. They take away the difficulty of usual social interaction and reduce the chance of rejection. Think how many people this technology might particularly help: introverts, people with disabilities that make it difficult to leave the house or even speak, deaf people, people with mental health problems, people who just find social interaction terrifying.

25

The internet could be just the thing to help us revive friendship.



Your notes

Text B: The limits of friendship

The following text is about the changing nature of friendship.

Robin Dunbar, an anthropologist working with primates some years ago, was researching why primates spend so much time in groups. He moved from there to humans and claimed that the average person could have up to 150 people in their social group. Anything beyond that is unmanageable. Since then, Dunbar has been exploring whether our ever-expanding social networks have done anything to change it.

5

Within the group of 150 only 5 will be your closest support group. Dunbar found that while the group sizes are stable, their composition is fluid. Your five today may not be your five next week.

As constant use of social media has become normal, people have challenged the relevance of Dunbar's number. Isn't it easier to have more friends when we have social media to help us to cultivate and maintain them? Our real-world friends tend to know each other but online we can expand our networks. Yet, 150 has remained constant, despite the ease of online connections compared with face-to-face ones.

10

However, social media is changing the nature of human interaction. It allows you to keep track of people who would otherwise disappear. What keeps face-to-face friendships strong is the nature of shared experience. The social media equivalent – sharing, liking, knowing that your friends have looked at the same cat video – lacks the synchronicity of shared experience. We've seen the same movie, but we cannot bond over it in the same way.

15

With social media, we can easily keep up with the lives of far more people. But without investing the face-to-face time, we lack deeper connections with them, and the time we invest in superficial relationships comes at the expense of more profound ones. We may widen our network to 400 people that we see as friends, but keeping up an actual friendship requires time. Putting in the effort to 'like', comment and interact with an ever-widening network means we have less time and capacity left for our closer friends – the ones that really matter.

20

After carefully reading the task, you should then read the texts and highlight the ideas and opinions that could inform your writing. Your response might use the following ideas from these texts:

Text A:

- The internet is blamed for everything without reason
- Loneliness, low self-confidence and social isolation are linked to social media, but it is not really known in what way
- The internet can make people less lonely, not more
- People can build meaningful connections over the internet



Your notes

- Social media can help people find friends and develop a social life
- You can be yourself on the internet as well as in person – our online and real-life personas are being merged
- Online friendships can be made across vast distances
- Talking and friendships online can be just as rich and as valid as in-person ones
- Befriending apps are now increasingly available
- Some people will find it easier to make friends online

Text B:

- Research shows how important real friendship is to people
- We are genetically wired to make a small number of close friends even in larger social groups
- Even though we now have the internet to help us maintain friendships across expanding distances, we don't actually have more friends with social media
- The nature of friendship is changing
- Shared experience in real life is essential for strong friendships
- Deeper connections take more effort than being online

Planning your response

Once you have read the text(s), identified relevant opinions, ideas and attitudes and bullet-pointed these in your own words, you should then spend five minutes planning your written response. In your plan:

- Decide on your “voice” and point of view
- Write a statement that summarises your point of view, based on your reading
- Note down which points you can develop that support your point of view in your first paragraph
- Decide if you are going to make a counter-argument, and note down which points you can develop to support this
- Return to your main argument, ensuring that you have included ideas and opinions from both texts (if more than one)
- Note down the points you can make to address the second bullet point in the task
- Note down how you are going to start and finish your response, ensuring that it establishes the correct style and tone

Article model answer

The following model answer demonstrates a top mark response to the above task:



Your notes

The heading uses alliteration to catch the reader's attention

The Muddling of Modern Friendships

We live in challenging times. Feelings of loneliness, isolation and disconnection rose sharply during the pandemic, leading to a significant increase in mental health issues, and all too often the blame is placed firmly at social media's door. But maybe traditional notions of friendship need to now be re-evaluated in this post-Covid and internet-driven world? We all use it, so is it maybe time to stop blaming social media, and start thinking more about how we can use it to positively influence our friendships?

The introduction uses persuasive devices and demonstrates an understanding of the task

Much of the prejudice against online friendships, mainly directed at the rise in the use of social media, tends to come from generations who have not grown up with the internet and who have not experienced it like our generation has. Lockdown has shown us just how important our online connections and friendships are, as without this way of keeping in touch, we all would have been truly isolated. "Online friendship" and "offline friendship" is somewhat of a false distinction: one shouldn't be seen as better than the other, as technology is now able to bring people together in more ways than ever before. Social media can actually help people to find friends, without the restrictions of geographical location. Friendships can be made and maintained over vast distances, and as we become more confident in the ways our online selves can emulate our offline selves, social media becomes an ever more rich and enriching platform for friendship.

This demonstrates awareness of the intended audience

Style, tone and voice are appropriate and consistent, using ideas contained in Text A

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved



Your notes

The first sentence of this paragraph demonstrates a sustained awareness of audience

Uses a specific reference to Text A, but in own words

Moves on to information and ideas from Text B

Use of a personal anecdote appropriate for an article

For people of our age, as we explore the direction we want our lives to take, we might find ourselves travelling or getting a job outside of where we grew up. This is where social media and the internet can actually help us find friends and fend off loneliness. There is an increase in the number of “making-friends” apps now available, removing the difficulty of finding places to make new friends and improving access to friendship groups for those for whom making in-person connections can be difficult.

Of course, we do not necessarily have “more” friends because of social media and the internet. Research has suggested that, no matter how many people we know, we tend to have no more than five “close” friendships. Yes, there is an argument about the importance of shared experience in developing these close bonds: that this is much more difficult to achieve online, and without investment in that face-to-face time we risk only having superficial relationships without any real and deep meaning. However, wouldn't it be better to be able to maintain that bond with a close friend who moves away via the internet, than let it disappear altogether? My closest friend is away travelling right now, and I would disagree with anyone who says that our continuing close friendship, which is currently conducted online, is in any way less valid than my relationship with my other friends who I see maybe once a month.

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved



Your notes

The final paragraph
explicitly addresses
the second bullet point

Social media can affect friendship, and not always in a positive way. But people drift apart in real life as well, and in an increasingly connected world, the nature of friendship itself is changing. Changes in how society itself operates, such as the increasing automation of everyday interactions, is as much to blame for feelings of loneliness and isolation as the internet and social media. In my opinion, safely and with responsibility, it is therefore more essential than ever before to embrace it.

A personal point of view is sustained throughout

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved

Unannotated model answer

The Muddling of Modern Friendships

We live in challenging times. Feelings of loneliness, isolation and disconnection rose sharply during the pandemic, leading to a significant increase in mental health issues, and all too often the blame is placed firmly at social media's door. But maybe traditional notions of friendship need to now be re-evaluated in this post-Covid and internet-driven world? We all use it, so is it maybe time to stop blaming social media, and start thinking more about how we can use it to positively influence our friendships?

Much of the prejudice against online friendships, mainly directed at the rise in the use of social media, tends to come from generations who have not grown up with the internet and who have not experienced it like our generation has. Lockdown has shown us just how important our online connections and friendships are, as without this way of keeping in touch, we all would have been truly isolated. "Online friendship" and "offline friendship" is somewhat of a false distinction: one shouldn't be seen as better than the other, as technology is now able to bring people together in more ways than ever before. Social media can actually help people to find friends, without the restrictions of geographical location. Friendships can be made and maintained over vast distances, and as we become more confident in the ways our online selves can emulate our offline selves, social media becomes an ever more rich and enriching platform for friendship.

For people of our age, as we explore the direction we want our lives to take, we might find ourselves travelling or getting a job outside of where we grew up. This is where social media and the internet can actually help us find friends and fend off loneliness. There is an increase in the number of "making-

friends” apps now available, removing the difficulty of finding places to make new friends and improving access to friendship groups for those for whom making in-person connections can be difficult.

Of course, we do not necessarily have “more” friends because of social media and the internet. Research has suggested that, no matter how many people we know, we tend to have no more than five “close” friendships. Yes, there is an argument about the importance of shared experience in developing these close bonds: that this is much more difficult to achieve online, and without investment in that face-to-face time we risk only having superficial relationships without any real and deep meaning. However, wouldn’t it be better to be able to maintain that bond with a close friend who moves away via the internet, than let it disappear altogether? My closest friend is away travelling right now, and I would disagree with anyone who says that our continuing close friendship, which is currently conducted online, is in any way less valid than my relationship with my other friends who I see maybe once a month.

Social media can affect friendship, and not always in a positive way. But people drift apart in real life as well, and in an increasingly connected world, the nature of friendship itself is changing. Changes in how society itself operates, such as the increasing automation of everyday interactions, is as much to blame for feelings of loneliness and isolation as the internet and social media. In my opinion, safely and with responsibility, it is therefore more essential than ever before to embrace it.



Your notes

Commentary:

- The heading uses alliteration to catch the reader’s attention
- The introduction uses persuasive devices and demonstrates an understanding of the task
- The answer demonstrates awareness of the intended audience, which is sustained throughout
- Style, tone and voice are appropriate and consistent, using ideas contained in Text A and Text B
- Any specific references to ideas or opinions in the text are put in the candidate’s own words
- The use of a personal anecdote is appropriate for an article
- The final paragraph explicitly addresses the second bullet point in the task
- A personal point of view is sustained throughout
- Spelling, grammar and punctuation are accurate throughout

**Examiner Tips and Tricks**

The suggested word count for this task is a guide, and you are not penalised for writing under or over 250–350 words. However, writing too little can mean that your answer does not have enough development or detail. Writing too much can mean that you go off topic and lose focus, which again

can be self-penalising. It is therefore a good idea to stick as closely as you can to the word count guidance.

Our model answers are not written in timed, exam conditions. We have therefore shown a range of points that could be included to answer this question, and provided a model you can use to help with the structure of your answer.

You can find further guidance on suggested word counts for CIE [here](#).



Your notes

Summary

- Remember to read the question carefully and highlight:
 - What you are writing, who your audience is and why you are writing
 - The focus of each bullet point
- Read the text(s) and highlight the relevant information that could be developed in your answer
- Bullet-point this information in your own words
- Plan your writing, focusing on one main idea or opinion per paragraph
- Address each bullet point in order:
 - Make sure you cover all of the bullet points as equally as possible
- Decide on the voice and style you want to create and maintain that in your answer
- Do not just repeat details from the text(s):
 - You need to evaluate and develop the ideas, opinions and attitudes in the text(s) – you are not summarising them